



“Technology has huge advantages. But we have to leverage tech for its disadvantages... If you look at the advantages of AI, then the tech price to pay to address its disadvantages is peanuts”

what suppliers. All of this will ensure that people don't feel that investment in India is a black box. Nobody has said it. But they want to know the policies and I want to make it easy and transparent [for investors]. We will also help them track the return on their investment and not just leave once the investment is done. For this, we have built a programme called Aftercare. That is how we are handholding investors. We are rebuilding our website, and these facilities will be available on that.

Q: What are your thoughts on the PLI scheme and how is it doing?

A: The PLI scheme is in 14 sectors, and we have a total outlay of ₹1.97 lakh crore. In that, we have 760 applications, who have already invested around ₹1.26 lakh crore. As of January 2024, a total of ₹4,415 crore has already been disbursed in eight sectors. The interesting thing is that **these eight sectors include [some of our PM 6] sectors—electronics, food, pharma, IT. So, 53% of the outlay or ₹1,04,220 crore is in these eight sectors.** In all, 55% of them are towards these four sectors of electronics, automobiles and auto components, solar PV modules and advanced chemistry cell (ACC).

You ask if these PLI schemes are working? The answer is, yes, absolutely. These are, I would say, accelerators. Our country needs to do a lot still in terms of manufacturing, compared to China. But there's a huge difference from where we were 10-15 years ago. To continue on this path of growing our manufacturing, we need partners. For those partners to not have any cost disadvantage, **I have to, as a nation, provide this crutch (of PLI) and this crutch is meant to support the investors till we as a nation address the cost of sales.** The US has a CHIPS Act (that provides incentives for chip manufacturing in the US) as over the last 15-20 years, manufacturing of semiconductors moved outside the US and Europe. The bulk of manufacturing landed up in countries like Taiwan and South Korea. The PLI scheme in India is working; we can see it in semiconductors. We are planning an investors' summit, and we will invite those companies and countries that will together build a strategy for India and not just India, but India for the world.

Q: Do you think India's aspiration to turn into a semiconductor hub is finally taking shape because we've seen a couple of investments coming in?

A: I would say the journey has begun. Every journey has a crawl, walk, [and] run. Right now, we are crawling, but I assure you in five years, we will be walking and running. Why five years? Because for any fab to manu-